

# Ryan Baltodano

## Applied AI Engineer | Product Design

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[angrove.app](#) | [Angrove case studies](#) | [github.com/rbaltodano](https://github.com/rbaltodano)

Product-minded developer building Angrove, a free, private AI study app that runs entirely on the iPhone, designed as a harness for learning rather than a chat window. Owns system architecture and product design, directing AI-assisted implementation and evaluation. Professional web design experience at PostcardMania; B.S. in Information Science.

## Featured Project

### Angrove | Creator & System Designer

2026 - Present

Independent iOS project in active development for private inquiry into philosophy and theology.

- Directed Gemma E2B LoRA fine-tuning and quantized LiteRT-LM export for on-device iOS inference; evaluated llama.cpp separately as an experimental runtime path.
- Designed on-device retrieval-augmented generation using Core ML MiniLM embeddings, bundled source passages, and citation and named-source lookup.
- Implemented embedding-space clustering for Insight Tree and weighted Midpoint blends with AI assistance.
- Designed a Python/FastAPI development backend for MLX inference, structured-output validation, priority-aware generation scheduling, and SQLite persistence; used AI tools to write the Python implementation.
- Evaluated model responses in a 49-response evidence-ablation study comparing automatic retrieval, verified passages, and no evidence to distinguish retrieval failures from generation errors.
- Investigated simulator and physical-device inference constraints, distinguishing GPU allocation failures from device limitations and documenting model/runtime tradeoffs.
- Created the Figma visual and interaction system and directed AI-assisted SwiftUI implementation, spanning conversation branching, contextual definitions, and persistent study history.

## Experience

### Web Designer | PostcardMania

2024 - Present

Design and deliver custom, responsive client websites, translating business requirements into individualized layouts and managing client-facing delivery deadlines.

### Front-End Web Development Intern | Cloud Carpenter

2024

Designed and built responsive client websites and interactive features using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP in collaboration with a development team.

### Customer Service Staff | Publix

2021 - Present

Handle cash operations, reconciliation, and daily bookkeeping while maintaining a concurrent professional design role.

## Skills & Technical Experience

**AI systems:** RAG, semantic search, model evaluation, LoRA and quantization workflows; MLX, LiteRT-LM, Core ML; llama.cpp research

**Applied Linear Algebra:** Vector embeddings, cosine similarity, normalization, nlerp, multidimensional projection

**System design:** Model integration, structured-output contracts, generation scheduling; FastAPI and SQLite backend architecture

**Design & web:** Figma, product and interaction design, design systems, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, MySQL

**Workflow:** AI-assisted implementation with Claude Code and Codex; Swift / SwiftUI application development, technical documentation

## Education

### B.S. in Information Science | University of South Florida

2023

Concentration in Information Security